

EAP PRE-SEASON AUDIT CHECKLIST

Because “we have a plan” and
“we have a plan that works”
are two very different sentences.



September is National Preparedness Month.

Before the checklists, webinars, and vendor emails flood in, use this audit to find out where your emergency action plan actually stands, not where you assume it stands.



HOW TO USE THIS:

Go section by section. Check the box if the answer is a confident yes. Leave it blank if it's a maybe, a “someone was supposed to,” or a no. Blank boxes are your action list.



6 CATEGORIES.
SIMPLE YES OR NO.
REAL CLARITY.

01



EVACUATION ROUTE DOCUMENTATION



Clear, current routes save time, reduce confusion, and save lives.

- | | | |
|---|---|--------------------------|
| 1 | Evacuation routes are posted in every work area, not just by the front door | ☐ |
| 2 | Routes reflect the current floor plan, not last year's floor plan | ☐ |
| 3 | Primary and secondary exit routes are both marked | ☐ |
| 4 | Assembly points are designated and known by staff | ☐ |
| 5 | Routes account for employees with mobility, vision, or hearing limitations | ☐ |

02



SHELTER-IN-PLACE PROTOCOLS



Shelter-in-place decisions must be clear, practiced, and ready.

- | | | |
|---|---|--------------------------|
| 1 | Written shelter-in-place procedures exist for relevant hazards (weather, chemical, active threat) | ☐ |
| 2 | Designated shelter locations are identified and accessible | ☐ |
| 3 | Staff know the difference between "evacuate" and "shelter" signals | ☐ |
| 4 | Shelter areas are stocked with basic supplies (water, first aid, flashlight) | ☐ |
| 5 | Procedures are reviewed regularly and whenever the plan or employee responsibilities change | ☐ |

03



COMMUNICATION TREE CURRENCY



Outdated contact info can break your plan when it matters most.

- | | | |
|---|---|--------------------------|
| 1 | Emergency contact list includes current phone numbers for all employees | ☐ |
| 2 | Communication tree has a backup method (call, text, app) if one fails | ☐ |
| 3 | At least one leader per shift knows their role in the notification chain | ☐ |
| 4 | Tree has been tested in the last 12 months, not just written and filed | ☐ |
| 5 | Updated contact info is collected as part of onboarding, not as an afterthought | ☐ |

04



UTILITY & VENDOR CONTACTS



When systems go down, the right contact makes all the difference.

- | | | |
|---|--|--------------------------|
| 1 | Emergency contacts for electric, gas, water, and HVAC vendors are current and accessible | ☐ |
| 2 | Contact list is available offline, not just saved in a system that needs power to open | ☐ |
| 3 | Building management or landlord contact info is included, if applicable | ☐ |
| 4 | At least one backup contact exists per vendor, not just one name and a prayer | ☐ |
| 5 | List is stored somewhere more than one person can find it | ☐ |

05



EMPLOYEE EMERGENCY TRAINING RECORDS



Training today prevents confusion tomorrow.

- | | | |
|---|---|--------------------------|
| 1 | Training records show who has completed emergency procedure training | ☐ |
| 2 | New hires receive emergency training during onboarding, not “eventually” | ☐ |
| 3 | Refresher training is documented on a recurring schedule | ☐ |
| 4 | Records identify who still needs training, by name | ☐ |
| 5 | Training covers role-specific responsibilities (fire wardens, first aid responders, etc.) | ☐ |

06



DRILL HISTORY



Drills reveal weaknesses while there's still time to fix them.

- | | | |
|---|--|--------------------------|
| 1 | Most recent drill date is documented and current per your industry's applicable requirements | ☐ |
| 2 | Drill included a full evacuation or shelter response, not a tabletop discussion only | ☐ |
| 3 | Issues found during the last drill were documented | ☐ |
| 4 | Documented issues were actually addressed, not just noted and forgotten | ☐ |
| 5 | Next drill date is already scheduled | ☐ |



SCORING YOURSELF

Count your checked boxes.

TOTAL SCORE

____ /25



25 to 30: Your plan is in good shape. Keep testing it.



15 to 24: You have a plan. It needs attention before it needs to work.



Under 15: Treat this as your starting checklist, not your finish line.